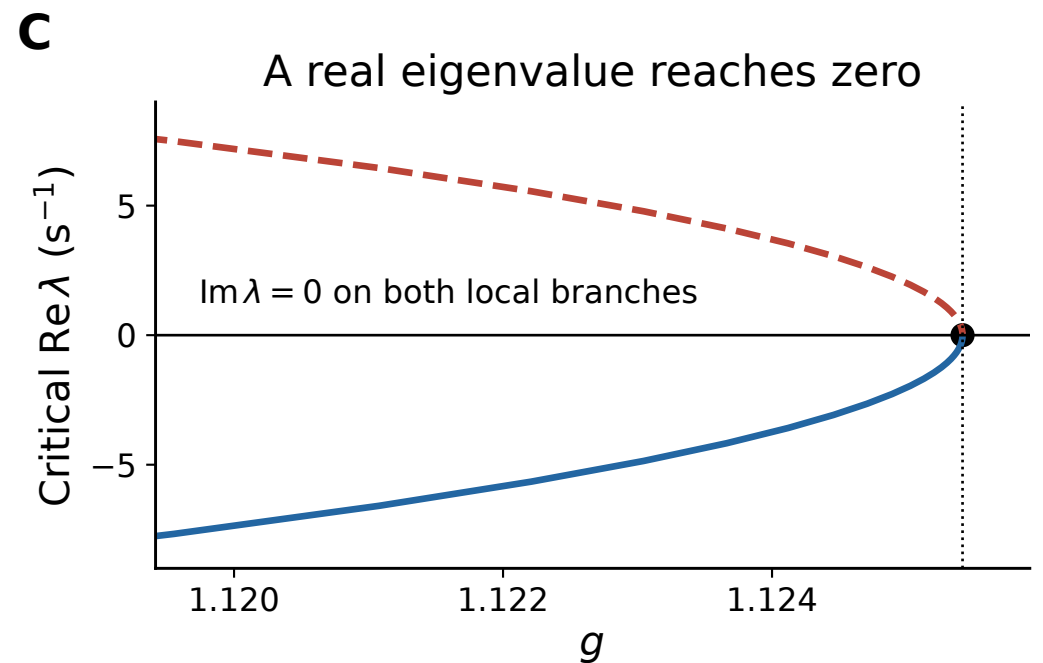
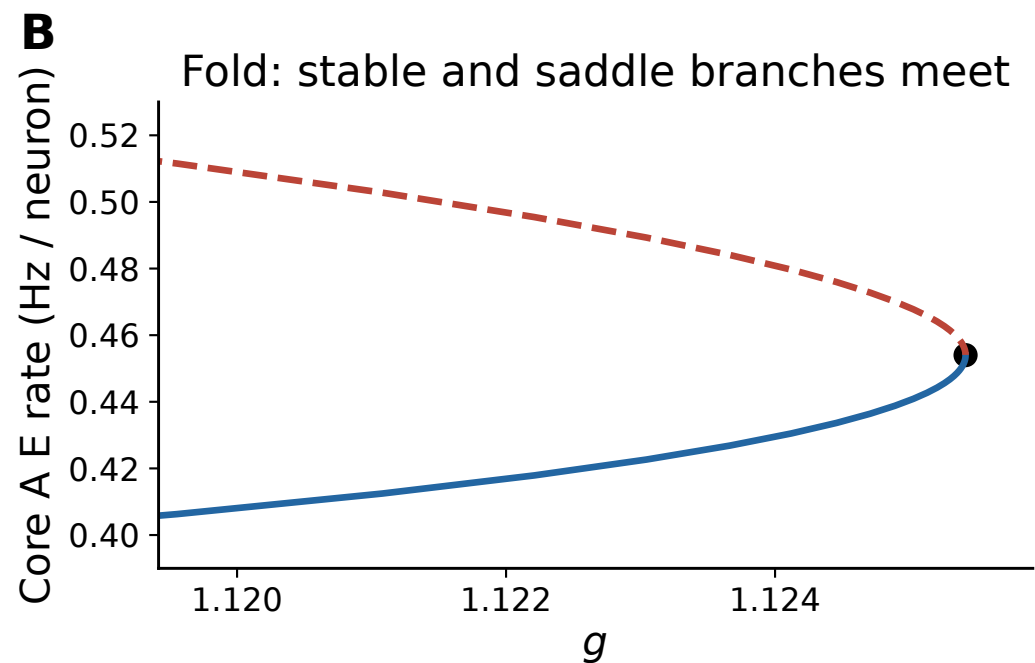
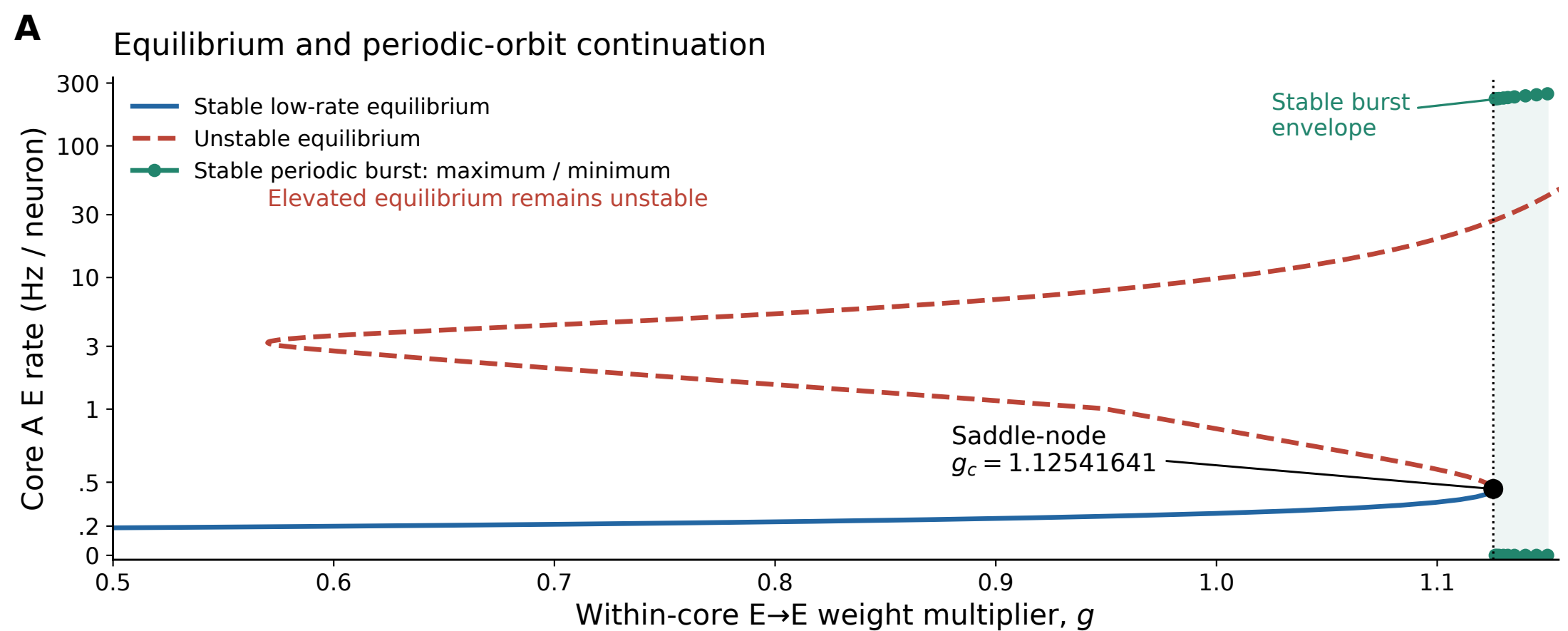
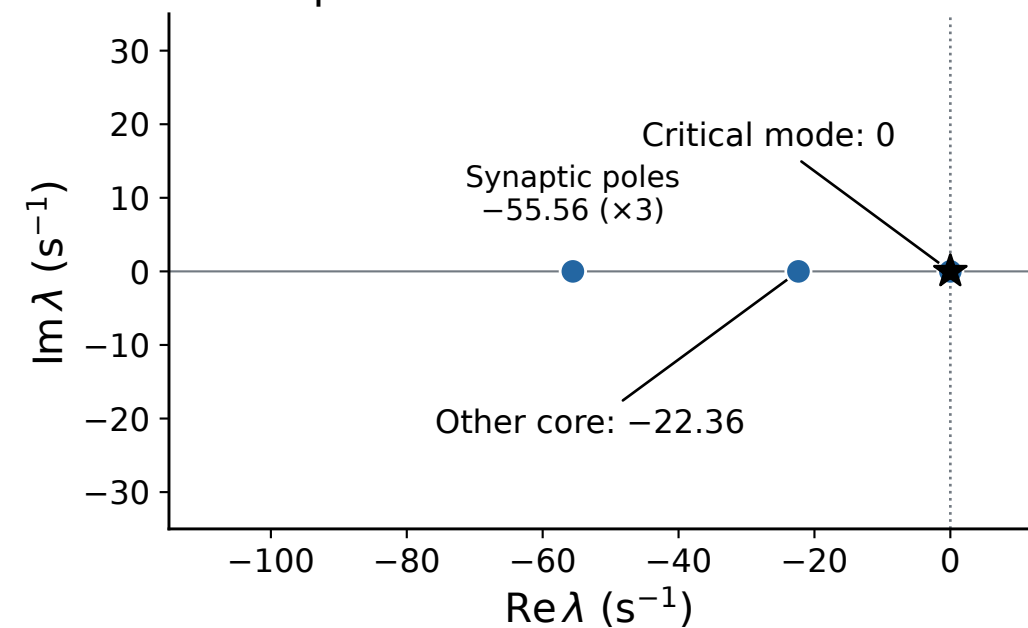
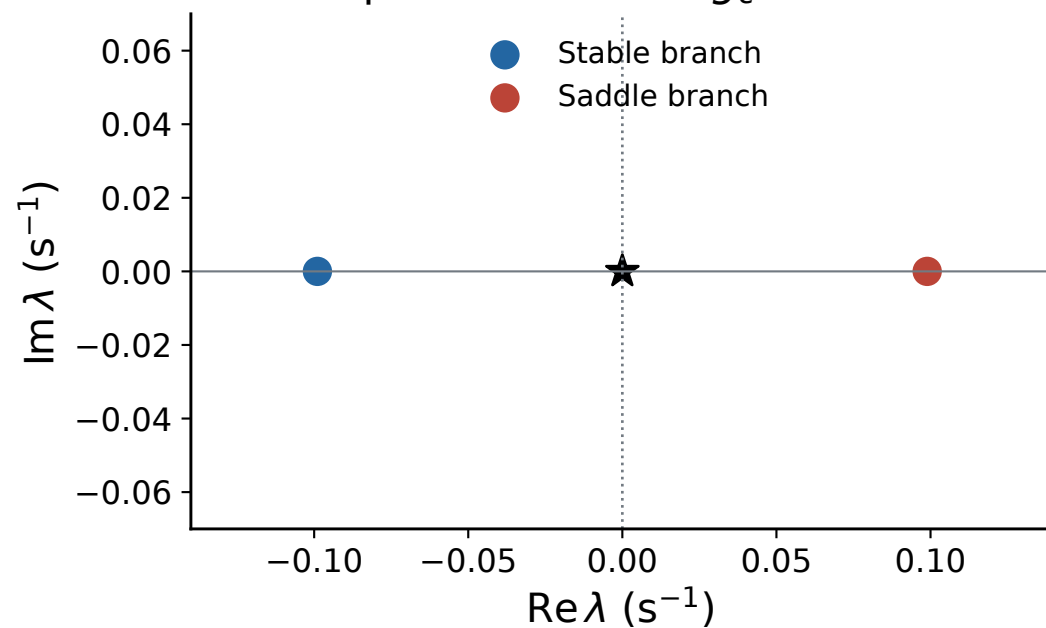


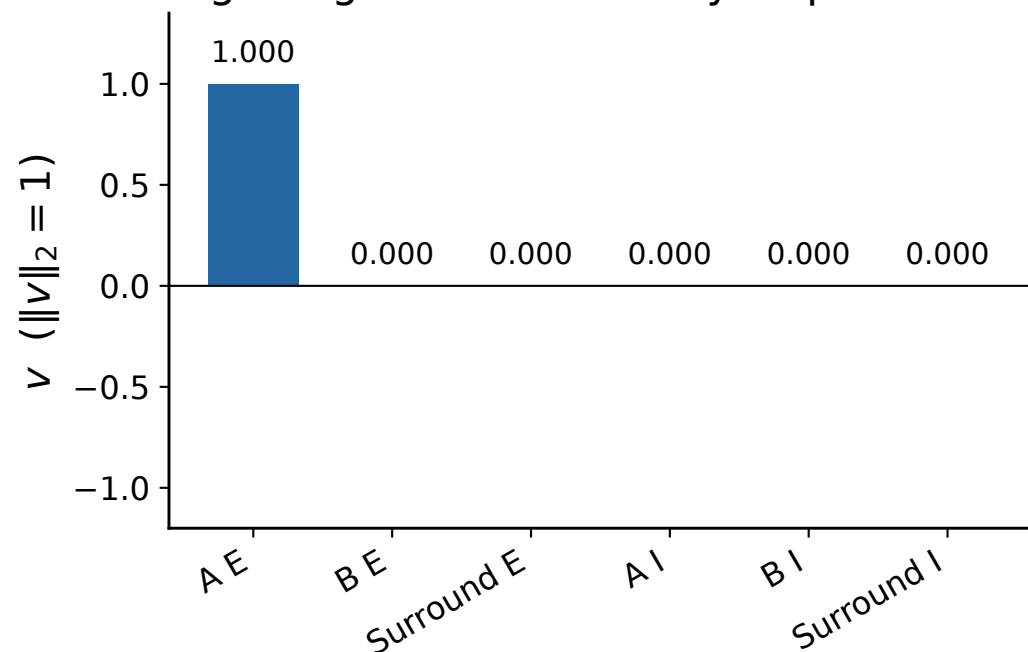


A

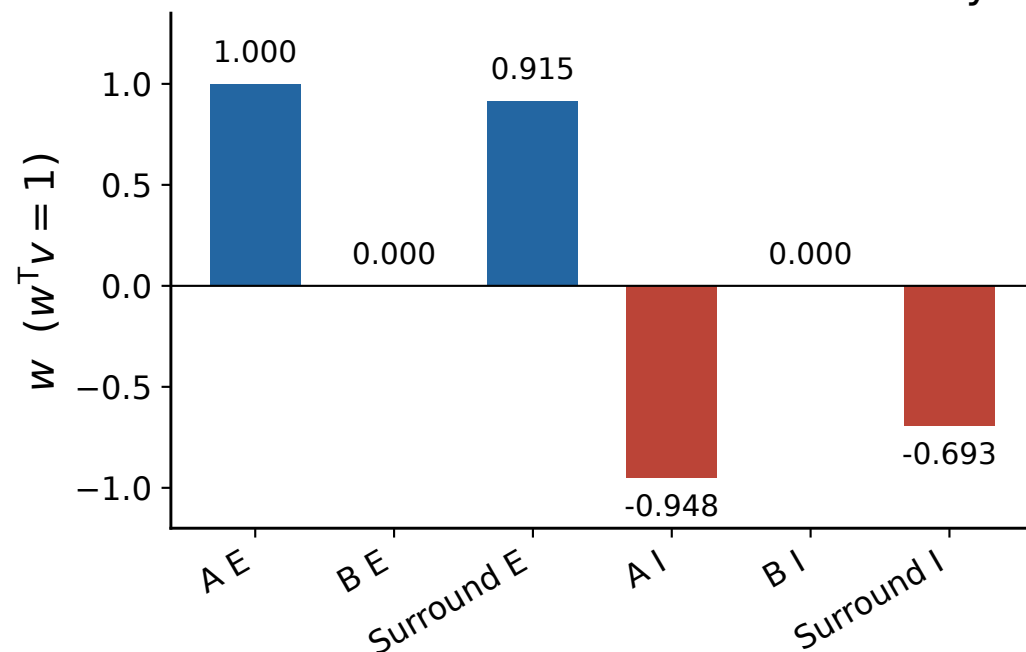
Spectrum at the low-rate fold

**B**Spectral zoom at $g_c = 10^{-6}$ **C**

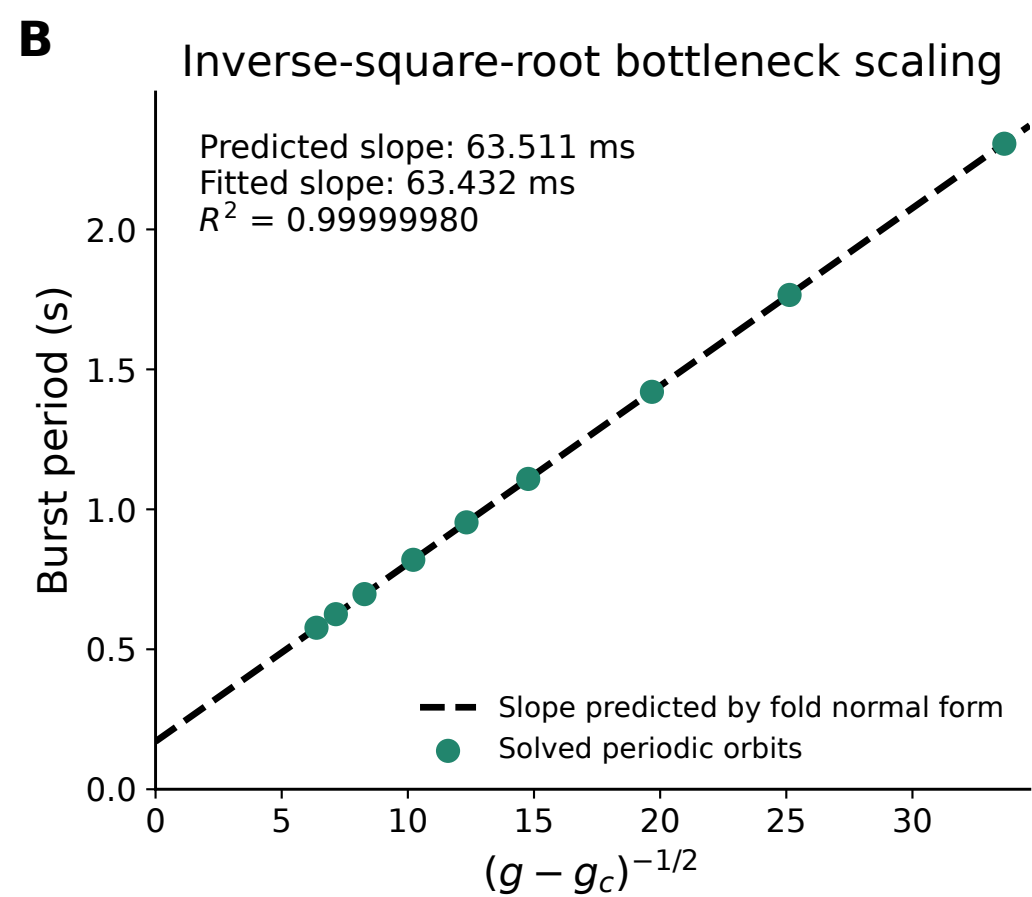
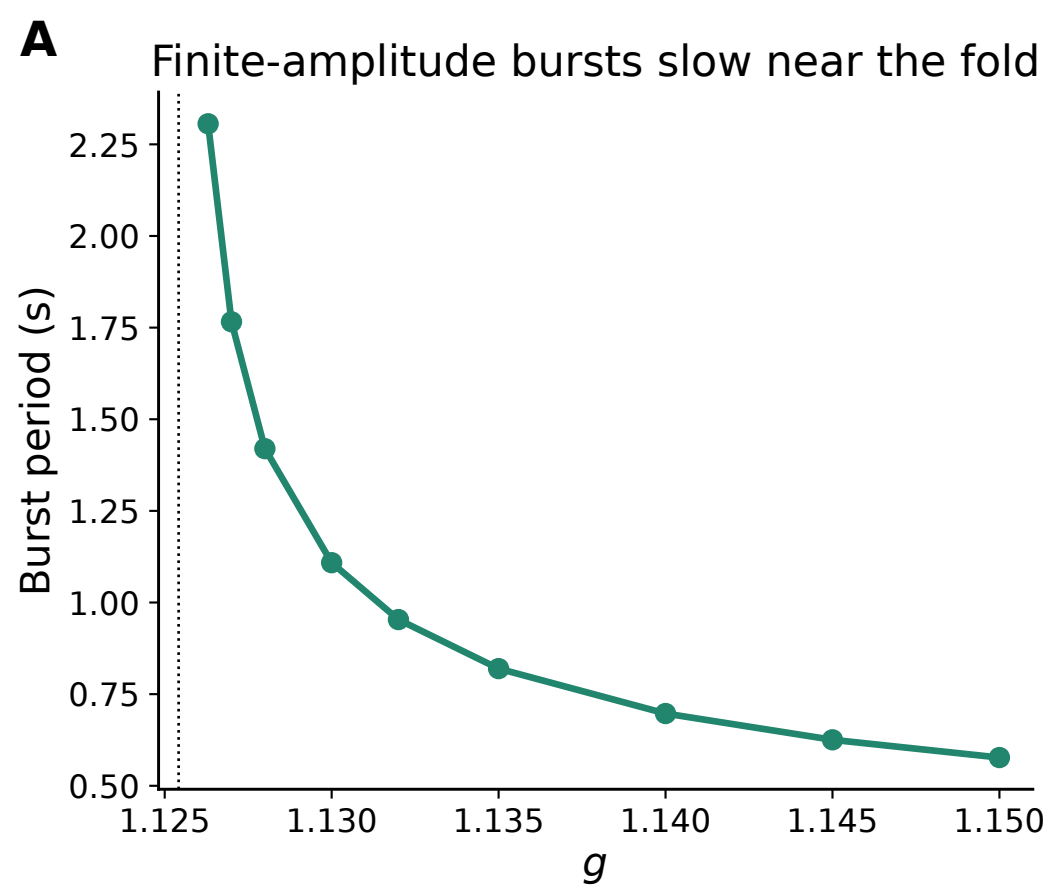
Right eigenvector: activity displacement

**D**

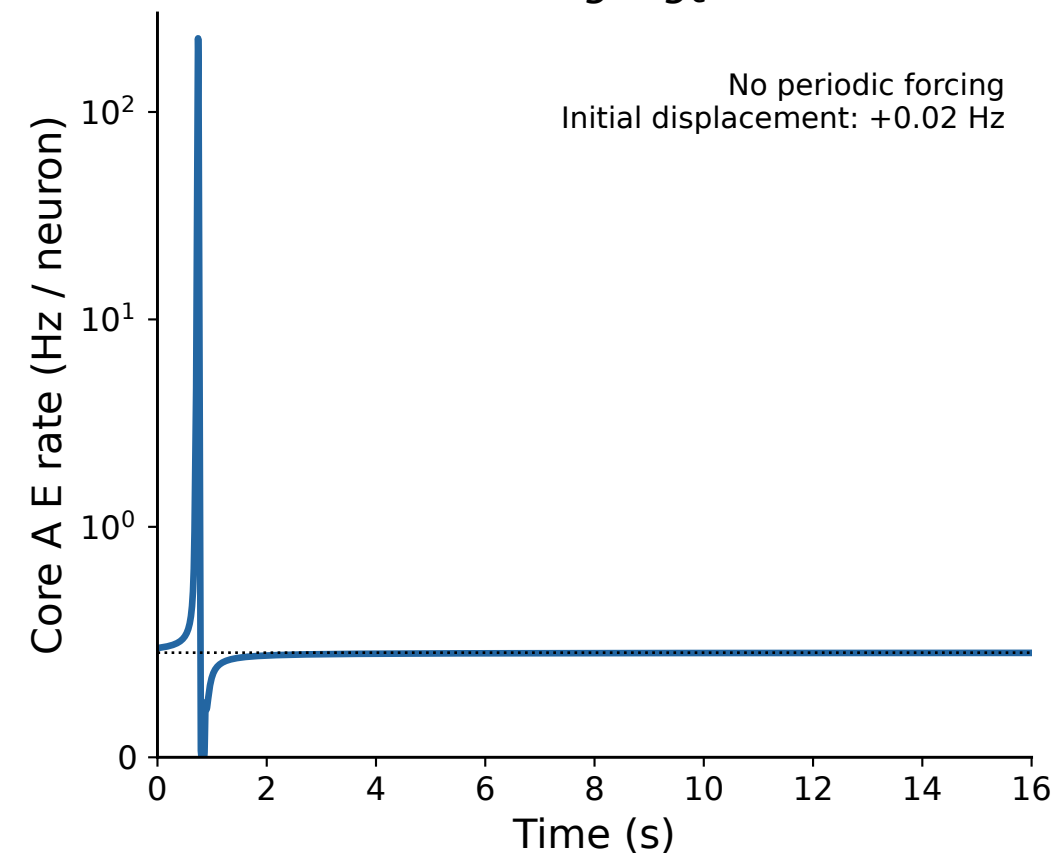
Left characteristic vector: sensitivity



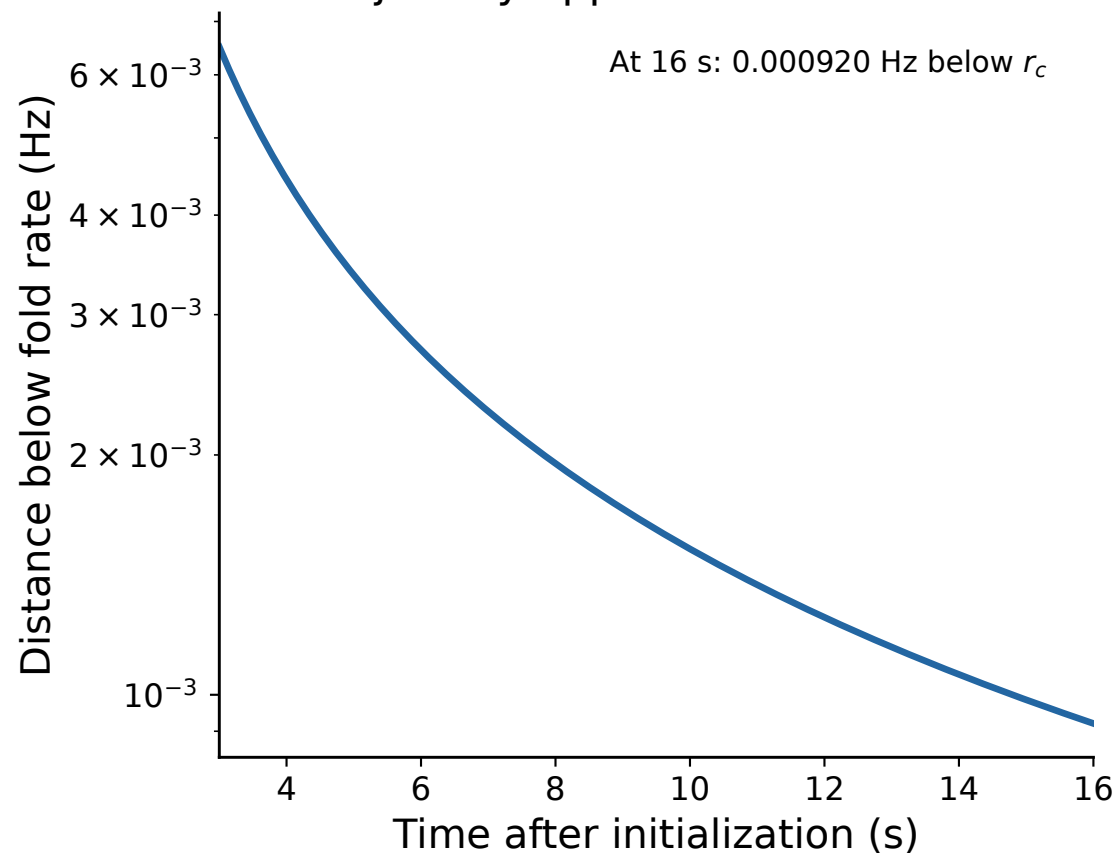
Six population coordinates; the projected mode does not resolve individual-neuron eigenvectors.



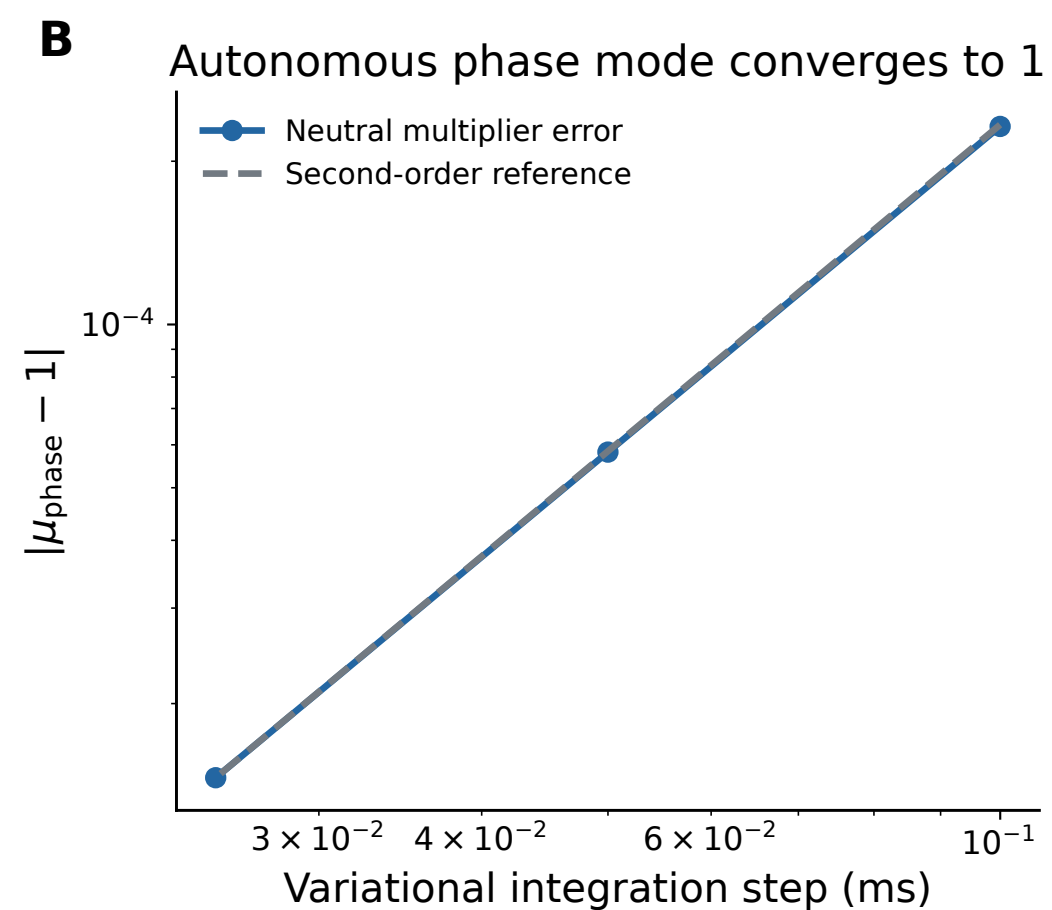
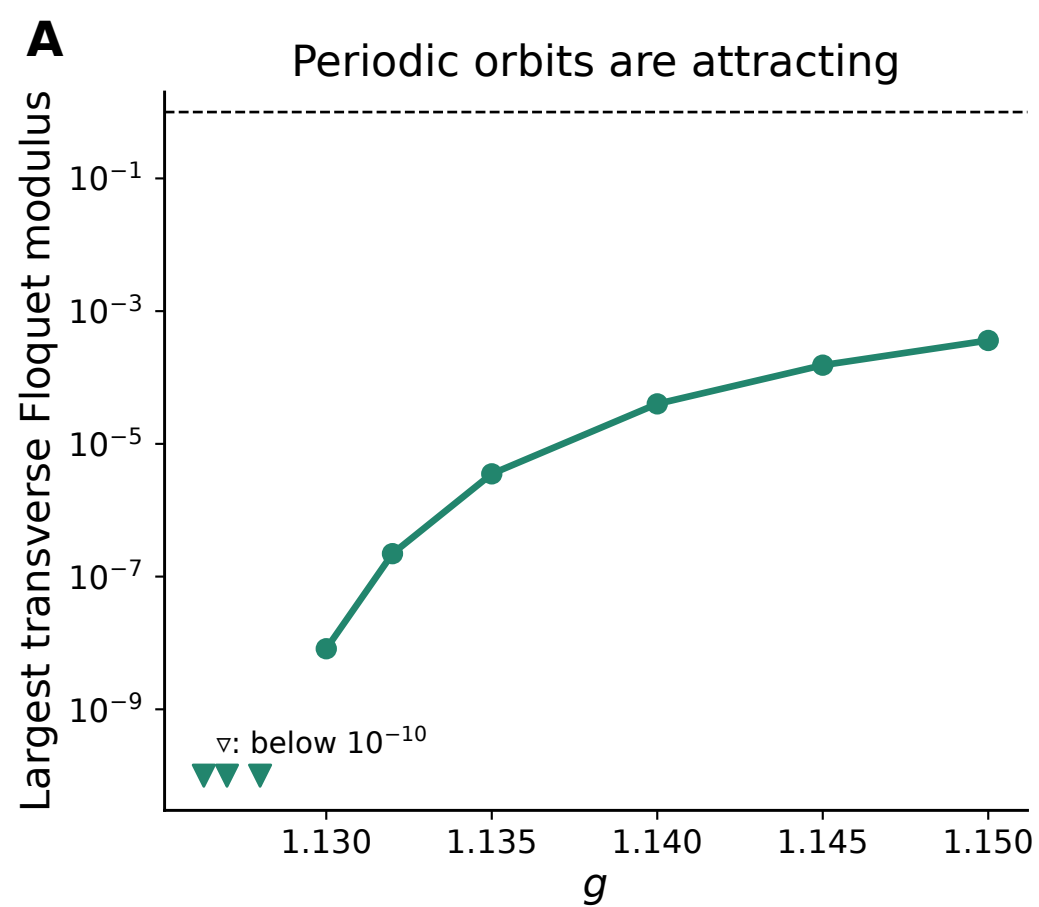
Local saddle-node confirmed; finite-period continuation and the global return support a SNIC-type onset.

AOne excursion at $g = g_c$, then return**B**

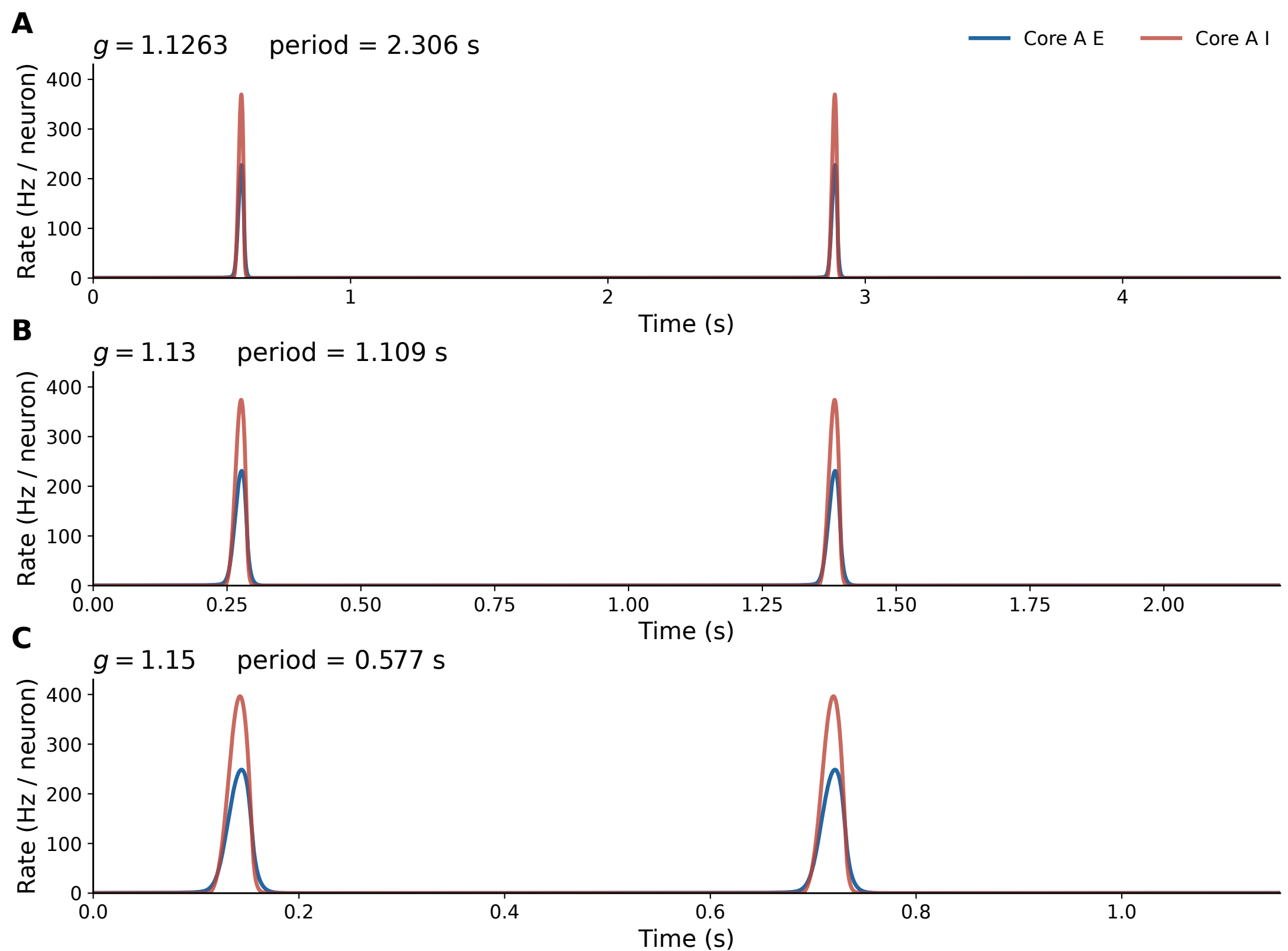
The trajectory approaches the same fold



The finite-time return is a numerical global-connection diagnostic, not a rigorous infinite-time proof.



Full delay-history monodromy; five leading multipliers; neutral phase direction excluded from transverse stability.



Waveforms reconstructed from solved periodic orbits; both firing rates refer to cells inside core A.